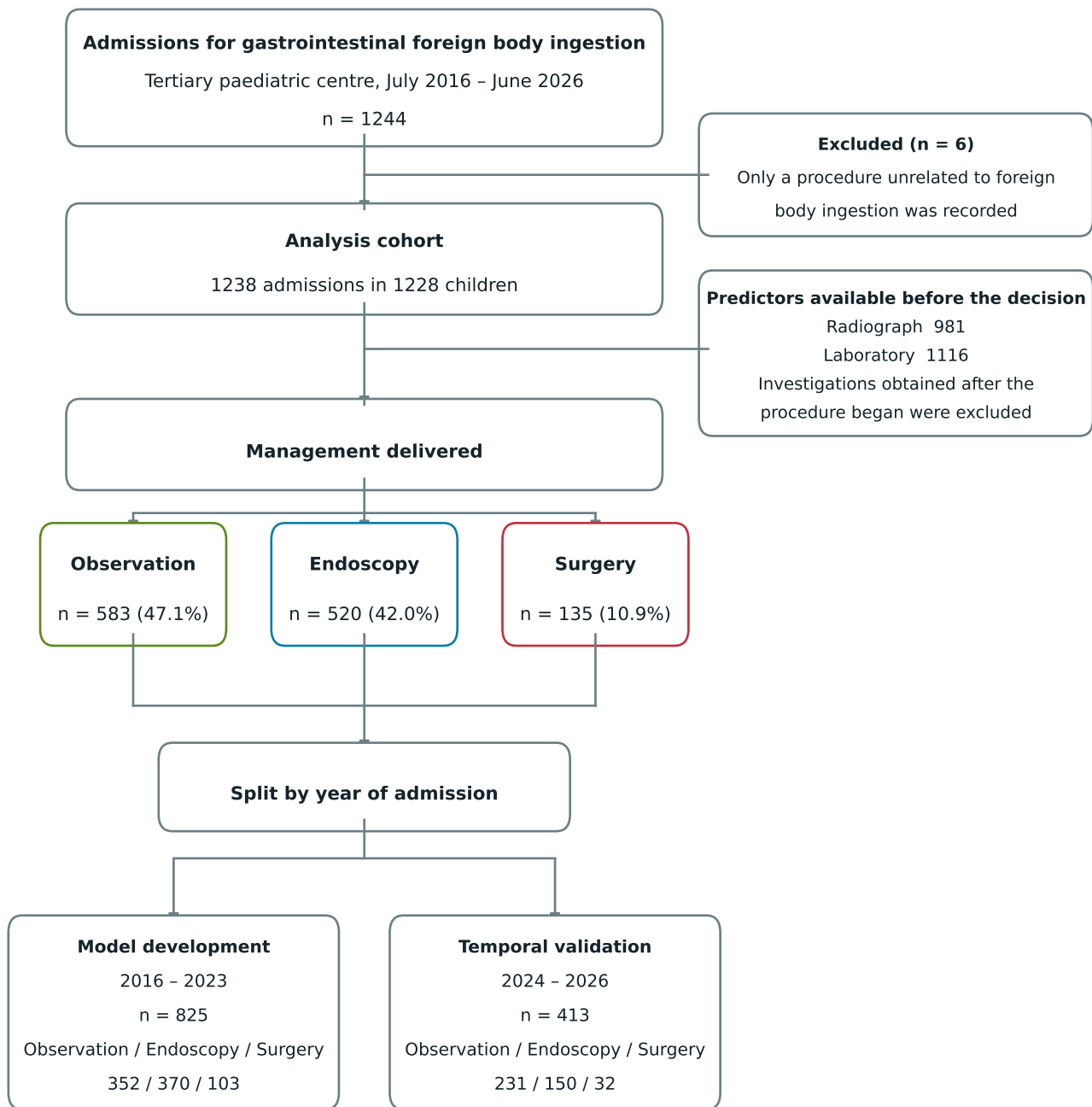




*Ten admissions in the observation class carry the coded diagnosis “procedure not performed for reasons attributable to the family”; these were excluded in a prespecified sensitivity analysis.*

Predictors were restricted to information available before the treatment decision, verified by comparing each investigation's timestamp against the recorded start of the procedure in the anaesthetic record.